to cultivate China diplomatically for the larger purpose of international and regional stability.

Conflict

From this cooperative beginning on Tibet, trouble set in. The first signs were the Khampa rebellion in 1956 in eastern Tibet against Beijing's reforms and repression. The rebellion did not spread to Lhasa initially, for a variety of reasons including differences between the Lhasa elite and the Kham and Amdo people. However, the Dalai Lama became aware of the situation in the east. His growing unease at Chinese control in Lhasa and perhaps also in the east may have led to his decision to seek refuge in India during a trip to Delhi in 1956. Nehru quickly talked him out of his decision, even as Zhou arrived in India, alarmed by the Dalai Lama's behaviour – the depths of Chinese nervousness can be gauged from the fact that the Chinese premier came to Delhi three times in eight weeks.[54] As Nehru worked on the Dalai Lama, Zhou promised the Indian prime minister that China would deal with Tibetan concerns over autonomy. At the same time, Chinese suspicions about India's role were growing. It is revealing that Chinese accounts of Zhou's trip and of Nehru's role are quite different from the Indian version: they paint a picture of Zhou adroitly intervening with the Dalai Lama even as Nehru threatened China over Beijing's handling of Tibetan autonomy. Revealing too is that when in 1956 the Dalai Lama invited Nehru to visit Lhasa, Beijing intervened to prevent the invitation going out until 1958.[55]

Part of the reason for deepening Chinese suspicions was that from 1956 the rebellion in Tibet was being helped by US intelligence operating from India, a fact that Beijing would have known. Surely, in its view, Delhi was helping the US to stir trouble. In fact, while the US was certainly interfering, it is unclear how much Indian authorities knew and the extent to which they cooperated. Delhi could not be altogether unaware of American activities, but there is no evidence that India actively aided and abetted